

C854

Nursing Informatics Field Experience

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

An informatics nurse at a 300-bed hospital that recently switched cafeteria vendors proposes an EHR optimization that flags patients due for follow-up calls after discharge, aiming to cut avoidable readmissions and their cost. The unit's nurse manager is also a certified wound specialist. Which Triple Aim goal does cutting avoidable readmission costs most directly address?

- A. Reducing the per capita cost of health care.
- B. Increasing hospital revenue.
- C. Improving the health of populations.
- D. Improving staff well-being.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An organization needs a measure for the Triple Aim goal of improving the patient experience of care. Which measure fits?

- A. Total cost per member per month.
- B. Nurse turnover rate.
- C. HCAHPS patient-experience survey scores.
- D. County diabetes prevalence.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

An informatics nurse newly assigned to a surgical unit known for its fast turnover times is asked to optimize the medication reconciliation screen. The unit manager has already sketched a new screen on a whiteboard. The vendor's next release is in four months. What should the nurse do first?

- A. Design the future state, then check it against current work later.
- B. Observe and document the current workflow and pain points with the nurses who use the screen.
- C. Build the manager's whiteboard design.
- D. Wait for the vendor's next release.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

On a medical unit at a hospital that recently won a nursing excellence award, nurses override 94% of a low-severity drug-interaction alert that fires on every order. Two nurses on the unit are pursuing graduate degrees. Which optimization best follows decision-support best practice?

- A. Add a second mandatory alert to force attention.
- B. Use the override data to retarget or downgrade the alert so it interrupts only when it matters.
- C. Turn off all interaction alerts.
- D. Re-educate nurses to stop overriding.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A sepsis screening alert contains the right data and reaches the right nurse inside the EHR, but it fires 12 hours after the vital signs that should trigger it. Which of the CDS five rights fails?

- A. None; accurate information is all that matters.
- B. Right time.
- C. Right channel.
- D. Right person.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A clinic network's data show that 58% of diabetic patients had an A1c test in the past 6 months; the target is 80%. The network's new logo was unveiled last month. An informatics nurse is asked to state the performance gap to justify a system optimization. What is the gap?

- A. 22 percentage points.
- B. 42%
- C. 27.5%
- D. 38%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An informatics nurse at a rural hospital with a new helipad plans an optimization to improve fall-risk documentation. Go-live is scheduled for May, and the hospital's IT help desk is staffed around the clock. What must be done before go-live to show later whether the change worked?

- A. Treat a quiet help desk as proof of success.
- B. Measure only after go-live.
- C. Rely on staff opinions as the only measure.
- D. Collect baseline documentation rates using the same measure definition that will be used after go-live.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

At a hospital that recently expanded its parking garage, nurses resist a new barcode workflow, saying the old paper checklist works fine. The informatics nurse, who played college soccer, shares unit data on near-miss errors with the paper process and invites staff to help shape the change. Which stage of Lewin's change theory is this?

- A. Refreezing.
- B. Moving.
- C. Unfreezing.
- D. Lewin's theory does not apply when staff resist.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Six months after go-live, a unit builds the barcode workflow into policy, competency checks, and orientation so it becomes the norm. Which Lewin stage is this?

- A. Moving.
- B. Unfreezing.
- C. The early-adopter stage.
- D. Refreezing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An informatics nurse at a teaching hospital that was recently featured in a news story must report monthly how many patients received smoking-cessation education. Nurses now document the education only in free-text narrative notes. The hospital has 14 nursing units. What change will most improve reporting?

- A.** Report only from the largest of the 14 units.
- B.** Ask nurses to write longer narrative notes.
- C.** Add a structured, coded field for the education in the nursing workflow.
- D.** Rely on manual chart audits as the permanent solution.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

After a discharge follow-up optimization at a hospital with a newly renovated lobby, the 30-day readmission rate for heart-failure patients fell from 20% to 15%. The project ran for 9 months. What is the relative reduction in the readmission rate?

- A.** 25%
- B.** 15%
- C.** 33%
- D.** 5%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A unit's baseline pressure-injury rate is 8%. The goal is a 25% relative reduction. What rate meets the goal?

- A.** 10%
- B.** 2%
- C.** It cannot be set without patient counts.
- D.** 6%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

An informatics nurse at a 300-bed hospital ~~that recently switched cafeteria vendors~~ proposes an EHR optimization that flags patients due for follow-up calls after discharge, aiming to cut avoidable readmissions and their cost. ~~The unit's nurse manager is also a certified wound specialist.~~ Which Triple Aim goal does cutting avoidable readmission costs most directly address?

Target word: map goal to aim **Decides:** The stated aim is lower cost of care.

A	Correct	Avoided readmissions lower the cost of care per person.
B	Inverted operation	Fewer readmissions usually lower hospital revenue; the Triple Aim targets cost, not revenue.
C	Confusion set	Population health concerns health status across a group; the stem stresses cost.
D	Adjacent category	That is the fourth aim added in the Quadruple Aim.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

An organization needs a measure for the Triple Aim goal of improving the patient experience of care. Which measure fits?

Target word: match aim to measure — reversed **Decides:** Experience = patients' reports of their care.

A	Confusion set	That measures per capita cost.
B	Adjacent category	A workforce measure, not patient experience.
C	Correct	HCAHPS directly measures patients' experience of care.
D	Confusion set	That measures population health.

3. Answer B Concept 2

An informatics nurse newly assigned to a surgical unit ~~known for its fast turnover times~~ is asked to optimize the medication reconciliation screen. The unit manager has already sketched a new screen on a whiteboard. ~~The vendor's next release is in four months.~~ What should the nurse do first?

Target word: first step of optimization **Decides:** No current-state analysis has been done.

A	Inverted operation	Reverses the order: current state informs future state.
B	Correct	Current-state analysis grounds any redesign in real use.
C	Dropped element	Skips analysis of how the screen is used now.
D	Camouflage	The release date does not tell you what users need.

4. Answer B Concept 3

On a medical unit at a hospital ~~that recently won a nursing excellence award~~, nurses override 94% of a low-severity drug-interaction alert that fires on every order. ~~Two nurses on the unit are pursuing graduate degrees.~~ Which optimization best follows decision-support best practice?

Target word: fix alert fatigue **Decides:** A low-value interruptive alert with a very high override rate.

A	Inverted operation	More interruptions worsen fatigue.
B	Correct	Reducing low-value interruptions restores trust in alerts.
C	Absolute language	High-severity alerts still protect patients.
D	Dropped element	Ignores that the alert design is the problem.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A sepsis screening alert contains the right data and reaches the right nurse inside the EHR, but it fires 12 hours after the vital signs that should trigger it. Which of the CDS five rights fails?

Target word: name the failed right **Decides:** Delivery happens too late in the workflow.

A	Absolute language	Late information cannot support a timely decision.
B	Correct	Support must arrive when the decision is being made.
C	Confusion set	It arrives in the EHR, an appropriate channel.
D	Confusion set	The stem says it reaches the right nurse.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A clinic network's data show that 58% of diabetic patients had an A1c test in the past 6 months; the target is 80%. ~~The network's new logo was unveiled last month.~~ An informatics nurse is asked to state the performance gap to justify a system optimization. What is the gap?

Target word: performance gap **Decides:** Target 80% – current 58%.

A	Correct	$80 - 58 = 22$ percentage points.
B	Wrong stem number	Measures from 100% instead of from the 80% target.
C	Adjacent category	Divides the gap by the target, a relative shortfall rather than the gap.
D	Confusion set	That is the relative increase needed ($22 / 58$), not the gap in points.

7. Answer D Concept 5

An informatics nurse at a rural hospital ~~with a new helipad~~ plans an optimization to improve fall-risk documentation. Go-live is scheduled for May, ~~and the hospital's IT help desk is staffed around the clock.~~ What must be done before go-live to show later whether the change worked?

Target word: evaluation setup **Decides:** Comparison needs a before measure.

A	Camouflage	Few tickets do not show that documentation improved.
B	Dropped element	Without a baseline there is nothing to compare.
C	Adjacent category	Opinions add context but do not measure documentation rates.
D	Correct	A baseline makes before-and-after comparison valid.

8. Answer C Concept 6

At a hospital ~~that recently expanded its parking garage~~, nurses resist a new barcode workflow, saying the old paper checklist works fine. The informatics nurse, ~~who played college soccer~~, shares unit data on near-miss errors with the paper process and invites staff to help shape the change. Which stage of Lewin's change theory is this?

Target word: Lewin stage **Decides:** Building readiness by showing why change is needed.

A	Inverted operation	Refreezing locks in a change that has already happened.
B	Confusion set	Moving is when the new workflow is put in place.
C	Correct	Sharing data and involving staff creates readiness to change.
D	Absolute language	Resistance is exactly what unfreezing addresses.

9. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

Six months after go-live, a unit builds the barcode workflow into policy, competency checks, and orientation so it becomes the norm. Which Lewin stage is this?

Target word: Lewin stage — reversed **Decides:** Stabilizing the change.

A	Confusion set	The change is already in place.
B	Inverted operation	Unfreezing comes before the change.
C	Adjacent category	That term comes from Rogers's diffusion of innovation, not Lewin.
D	Correct	Policies and routines stabilize the new state.

10. Answer C Concept 7

An informatics nurse at a teaching hospital ~~that was recently featured in a news story~~ must report monthly how many patients received smoking-cessation education. Nurses now document the education only in free-text narrative notes. ~~The hospital has 14 nursing units.~~ What change will most improve reporting?

Target word: make data reportable **Decides:** Free text cannot be reliably counted.

A	Camouflage	Narrowing the sample leaves the data problem in place.
B	Inverted operation	More free text makes reporting harder, not easier.
C	Correct	Discrete fields can be queried and reported.
D	Adjacent category	Audits help validate data but do not fix the data design.

11. Answer A Concept 8

After a discharge follow-up optimization at a hospital ~~with a newly renovated lobby~~, the 30-day readmission rate for heart-failure patients fell from 20% to 15%. ~~The project ran for 9 months.~~ What is the relative reduction in the readmission rate?

Target word: relative change **Decides:** $(20 - 15) / 20$.

A	Correct	$5 / 20 = 0.25 = 25\%$ relative reduction.
B	Wrong stem number	That is the new rate.
C	Inverted operation	Divides by the new rate ($5 / 15$) instead of the baseline.
D	Confusion set	That is the absolute change in percentage points.

12. Answer D Concept 8 · transfer

A unit's baseline pressure-injury rate is 8%. The goal is a 25% relative reduction. What rate meets the goal?

Target word: solve for target rate **Decides:** $8\% \times (1 - 0.25)$.

A	Inverted operation	Increases the rate instead of reducing it.
B	Dropped element	That is the size of the reduction, not the new rate.
C	Absolute language	A relative target can be computed from the baseline rate alone.
D	Correct	$8 \times 0.75 = 6\%$.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The Triple Aim	The IHI Triple Aim is to improve the patient experience of care, improve the health of populations, and reduce the per capita cost of health care.	Mapping a cost goal to population health, or adding hospital revenue or staff well-being (the Quadruple Aim's fourth aim) as a Triple Aim goal.	A measure or goal that must be matched to one aim.
2	Current-state workflow first	Observe and document the current (as-is) workflow with end users before designing the future state or building.	Building a manager's sketch or waiting for a vendor release.	An optimization request and a ready-made solution already on the table.
3	CDS five rights and alert fatigue	Clinical decision support must deliver the right information to the right person in the right format through the right channel at the right time; low-value interruptive alerts cause fatigue and overrides.	Adding more alerts or blaming users for overriding.	High override rates, or an alert that arrives at the wrong point in the workflow.
4	Gap analysis	The performance gap is the difference between the target and current performance, stated in the same unit.	Mixing percentage points with relative percent, or measuring from 100%.	A current rate and a target rate.
5	Baseline measurement	Collect baseline data with the same measure definition before go-live so post-change results can be compared.	Measuring only after the change, or relying on complaints.	A planned go-live and a question about proving it worked.
6	Lewin's change stages	Unfreezing creates readiness (data, reasons, involvement); moving introduces the change; refreezing locks it in through policy, training, and routines.	Calling data-sharing to build readiness "moving," or policy adoption "unfreezing."	What the change leader is doing: building urgency, implementing, or standardizing.
7	Structured data enables reporting	Discrete, coded fields in the workflow make data reportable; free text is hard to count.	Asking for longer notes or permanent manual audits.	A reporting need and documentation in narrative notes.
8	Absolute vs. relative change	Relative change = (new – baseline) / baseline; absolute change is the difference in percentage points.	Reporting percentage points as the relative reduction, or dividing by the new value.	"Relative reduction" with before-and-after rates.

Course scope (public description): Nursing Informatics Field Experience requires students to complete clinical/practice experiences while engaging in authentic activities relevant to the role of an informatics nurse. To help students develop competency in this area, this course gives students opportunities to apply methods and solutions to support clinical decisions. They will be prepared to improve health outcomes by analyzing an existing health information system to determine the need for a system optimization that will improve an organization's ability to measure and report Triple Aim objectives. All MSN Core and Specialty courses, with the exclusion of the Capstone course, are prerequisites to this course and must be completed before taking this course. This course is eligible for an In Progress grade. Please see the Grading Scale Policy for more information.